

APRATIM SAHA

SUBRATA GUPTA
Additional Chief Secretary, West Bengal

FRUITS OF A JUGAAD

An ingenious solution by a **bureaucrat helps augment livelihood opportunities** for horticulturists in North Bengal

By ARKAMOY DATTA MAJUMDAR *in Darjeeling*

When a bureaucrat is a number-cruncher, the warp and weft of digits throw up solutions to problems that would pass others by. Subrata Gupta, who has a PhD in electronics and telecommunication from IIT Kharagpur, is additional chief secretary in the government of West Bengal in charge of the food processing industries and the horticulture department. He tweaked a Union government scheme to help horticulture farmers in the hills of Darjeeling and Kalimpong multiply their produce.

The key intervention was erecting over 2,500 polyhouses—using the concept of greenhouse farming, the practice involves fully or partially cov-